

Rahul Sharma

Project Lead - Game Testing & Project Management

I work as a Project Lead in Game Testing and manage project releases under the Project Management Department, taking ownership through end-to-end testing and crunch time — from test strategy and delivery scope to schedule, stakeholders and the final release call. 7+ years delivering for European, US, UAE and Indian studios, on PC, console, mobile and web.

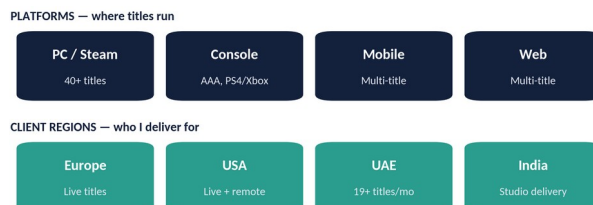
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40+	4	10+	4	94.4%
Games tested and released live	Client regions: EU, US, UAE, India	QA engineers trained and deployed across all projects	Platforms: PC, Console, Mobile, Web	Build pass rate, latest release

What I bring to your project

- **One accountable owner for QA and delivery.** You get a single point of contact who writes the defect up and decides whether the build ships — not a QA lead and a separate project manager who have to sync with each other.
- **A process that scales to your team, not the other way round.** Currently running QA for a team of 10+ engineers across 40+ live Steam titles for European and US studios, plus 19+ UAE indie-studio titles every month — in parallel, without losing individual project visibility.
- **Release discipline you can put a date against.** Every build I sign off has passed written exit criteria — not a gut call. Both fixed-deadline engagements referenced in this document shipped on their agreed date.
- **AAA console pedigree, casual-to-iGaming breadth.** Console multiplayer at Ubisoft (For Honor, PS4/Xbox/PC), through to casual, puzzle, strategy, action and real-money iGaming titles currently in market.

Where and what I delivered



Why one owner, not two

My QA team does end-to-end manual testing. I manage the team, own the project, and own release management — so the release decision never waits on a handoff between a separate QA lead and a separate PM.

The usual way	How I run it
A QA lead flags a defect; a separate PM decides the release call — two people, two inboxes, a delay while they sync	My team manually tests and logs the defect; I review it and make the ship/hold call myself — no handoff to a separate PM, no lag between a problem surfacing and a decision getting made
Status updates get filtered through whoever remembers to send them	My team reports to me daily; I send you status on a fixed weekly cadence, and any incident reaches you within 1 day of discovery, in writing
Team headcount is fixed for the life of the project, whether the workload matches it or not	I size and manage my team to match project phase, with every staffing change made as a written trade-off against schedule and cost

What the full portfolio shows you

This document is two pages of outcomes. The 24-page Master Portfolio behind it has what a technical reviewer would want: redacted Jira exports, a requirements-traceability audit with my own errors found and corrected, and the triage decisions behind a not-ready-for-release call.

How I run your project

The delivery model

Your schedule and budget are fixed at the start, in writing: an 8-stage plan from initial planning through post-release testing, with a sign-off gate at every stage. Day to day, the work inside test execution runs in short cycles — a new build, a daily report, continuous retesting — so you see risk building in real time instead of finding out at the deadline.

Release management: what a build must clear before it ships

Stage	What has to be true
Dev build	Smoke and functional testing pass; core loop is stable enough to test further
Beta build	Full progression, exploratory and interrupt testing complete across every mode
Release-candidate	Every defect checked against written exit criteria; no unresolved Highest/High-severity issue without a signed waiver
Live	A further verification pass on the real, published build — confirming what players get matches what was signed off

Results from two recent engagements



Casual PC title, Collector's Edition (2024)	Fixed live date held under pressure: absorbed the project's peak defect month before a planned staffing cut, and still closed all 212 defects with zero reopened at handover. 94.4% test-case pass rate.
Action-campaign PC title, release assessment (2023)	Inherited an unreviewed 152-defect backlog with 84% held by one developer. Delivered an evidence-based not-ready-for-release call, a P0/P1 fix plan, and a Jira process fix that is still in use.

Test artifacts for both engagements — test plans, Jira exports, daily reports, signed closure reports — are available in the Master Portfolio.

What an engagement looks like

Project management, covered end to end

Discipline	What you get
Project delivery	A staged plan from initiation to closure, with a written schedule, entry/exit criteria and a signed closure report
Stakeholder management	Weekly status reports; any incident escalated and reported to you within 1 day of discovery; closure signed off in writing, never assumed
Resource allocation	Headcount matched to project phase — not fixed for the life of the project — with every staffing change made as a written trade-off against schedule and cost
People management	Daily task allocation; new team members paired with an experienced one before working solo; knowledge-transfer sessions whenever a new defect class emerges
Team training	A structured learning plan (Selenium, Appium, TestNG/JUnit, C#) and ISTQB preparation, so your project benefits from a team that keeps improving mid-engagement
Release management	Builds gated dev → beta → release-candidate → live against written exit criteria, detailed on page 2
Environment setup	Hardware matrix, project and permissions access, network simulators — all agreed and ready before day one of testing
SOP creation	A Bug Reporting SOP, Testing Procedure and defect lifecycle documented in writing, so delivery does not depend on any one person's memory

Tools and methodologies

Test management: Jira (Admin, workflows, sprint boards), TestRail, MS Excel. Engines: Unity3D, Unreal Engine 5. Dev/data: GIT, MySQL, MongoDB, Postman, Swagger, CI/CD. Methods: Agile / Scrum / Sprint planning, Waterfall, hybrid staged-plus-iterative delivery.

Recognition

Recognised with 1st Runner-Up at Ubisoft India's 2020 Battleground QA event (For Honor) and a Spot Award for Active Testing Excellence at Indium Software.

Let's talk about your next release. I'm glad to walk through how this would run against your team's specific stack, timeline and platform mix — including the parts of past projects that did not go to plan. Reach me at mrrahulsharma@yahoo.com or +91-7217704787.